



House of Representatives

General Assembly

File No. 526

February Session, 2026

House Bill No. 5553

House of Representatives, April 8, 2026

The Committee on Government Administration and Elections reported through REP. BLUMENTHAL of the 147th Dist., Chairperson of the Committee on the part of the House, that the bill ought to pass.

AN ACT CONCERNING MINOR AND TECHNICAL CHANGES TO AN ABSENTEE VOTING STATUTE.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Section 9-153a of the 2026 supplement to the general
2 statutes is repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof
3 (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

4 The form of absentee ballot application provided by any federal
5 department or agency, referred to in section 9-140, may be used only by
6 a person in any one of the following categories who is eligible to vote
7 and who expects to be unable to appear at his proper polling place for
8 any reason specified in section 9-135: (1) Members of the armed forces
9 and their spouses and dependents, (2) [the spouses and dependents of
10 such members, (3)] members of religious groups or welfare agencies
11 assisting members of the armed forces, who are officially attached to
12 and serving with the armed forces, and their spouses and dependents,
13 [(4)] (3) civilian employees of the United States in all categories serving

14 outside the territorial limits of the several states of the United States and
 15 the District of Columbia and their spouses and dependents when
 16 residing with or accompanying them, whether or not the employee is
 17 subject to the civil service laws and the Federal Classification Act of
 18 1949, and whether or not paid from funds appropriated by the Congress,
 19 [(5)] (4) citizens of the United States temporarily residing outside of the
 20 territorial limits of the several states of the United States and the District
 21 of Columbia, and [(6)] (5) overseas citizens qualified to vote under the
 22 Uniformed and Overseas Citizens Absentee Voting Act, 100 Stat. 924, 42
 23 USC 1973ff et seq., as amended from time to time. Any such person may
 24 apply for an absentee ballot in the manner provided in section 9-140,
 25 either on the form prescribed by the Secretary of the State under section
 26 9-140 [,] or on the application form provided by any federal department
 27 or agency. [hereinbefore referred to.]

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
---	--	--

Section 1	October 1, 2026	9-153a
-----------	-----------------	--------

GAE *Joint Favorable*

The following Fiscal Impact Statement and Bill Analysis are prepared for the benefit of the members of the General Assembly, solely for purposes of information, summarization and explanation and do not represent the intent of the General Assembly or either chamber thereof for any purpose. In general, fiscal impacts are based upon a variety of informational sources, including the analyst's professional knowledge. Whenever applicable, agency data is consulted as part of the analysis, however final products do not necessarily reflect an assessment from any specific department.

OFA Fiscal Note**State Impact:** None**Municipal Impact:** None**Explanation**

The bill makes minor and technical changes to the existing absentee voting statute resulting in no fiscal impact to the state or municipalities.

The Out Years**State Impact:** None**Municipal Impact:** None

OLR Bill Analysis

HB 5553

***AN ACT CONCERNING MINOR AND TECHNICAL CHANGES TO AN
ABSENTEE VOTING STATUTE.***

SUMMARY

This bill makes technical changes to an absentee voting statute.

EFFECTIVE DATE: October 1, 2026

COMMITTEE ACTION

Government Administration and Elections Committee

Joint Favorable

Yea 13 Nay 6 (03/23/2026)